

Fly GACA — Go-to-Market: Flight Schools (B2B-First)

SECTION 07-gtm TYPE document STATUS **active** OWNER Founder UPDATED 2026-06-16

Status: plan, not built · **Maps to:** `roadmap.md` Phase 5, `office/spec-instructor-dashboard.md`
Prepared: 2026-05-30 · **Companion:** `strategy-competitive-teardown.md`

The roadmap puts Schools in Phase 5, after a long consumer build and behind the legal entity. This document argues for the opposite sequencing — **B2B before consumer-paid** — and lays out the motion to land the first academies. The thesis from the competitive teardown: this market is small enough to be **winner-take-most, and it is won through institutions, not SEO**.

Not legal advice. Live invoicing depends on the legal entity (`phase0.md` P0-3) and ZATCA onboarding (`roadmap.md` Phase 5). A pilot can run on a manual contract before that lands.

1. Why B2B-first beats consumer-first here

	Consumer freemium (current plan)	B2B-first (this doc)
Buyer count to meaningful revenue	hundreds of individuals at SAR 49/mo	3–5 institutions at SAR 149–249/seat/yr
Revenue per close	~SAR 49/mo, high churn	annual contract, 20–200 seats , low churn
Engagement data for the AI	scattered, self-selected	captive cohorts generating dense usage data
Defensibility	none — features are cloneable	switching cost + reference logo per school
Gate	needs full paywall + payments	a contract + a roster + a dashboard

A signed academy delivers three compounding assets at once: revenue, a reference logo that makes the next school trivial, and the cohort data that makes Captain Adel and the exam-readiness analytics measurably better than any self-serve competitor's.

2. Target segments (Saudi, in priority order)

1. **GACA-approved ATOs / flight academies** — the core. Cadets sit GACA written exams; the school carries the pass-rate risk. This is the seat-licence buyer.

2. **Aviation faculties / technical colleges** running ground school.
3. **Type-rating & conversion shops** serving foreign pilots entering the Kingdom — these feed the Conversion Prep Pack line directly.
4. **Corporate / GA flight departments** with recurrency and currency-tracking needs.

Maintain the live prospect list in a private CRM, not in-repo — it is personal/commercial data and the repo is public. This doc holds the *motion*, not the contacts.

3. The offer

Anchored on the decided price sheet (`roadmap.md` Phase 5):

- **SAR 249 / seat / year**, tiering to **199 at 25+** and **149 at 75+ seats**.
- **Admin dashboard included** — cohort exam-readiness, per-cadet progress, who's falling behind (the genuine instructor tool, built per `spec-instructor-dashboard.md`).
- Annual contract; ZATCA-compliant invoicing once the entity is live.
- **Pilot-program pricing** for the first 2–3 logo schools: a discounted or partly-free first cohort in exchange for a reference and a testimonial. The logo is worth more than the margin.

The wedge in the pitch: built on **GACAR** (not FAA), every quiz answer cited to the exact Part, the only platform pairing Saudi regulation with real accident lessons, and bilingual. No FAA-based incumbent (Gleim, Sporty's, King) can say any of that.

4. The motion (no entity required to start)

1. **Build the demo asset** — a one-page school deck + a live dashboard walkthrough on seeded demo data. Lead with cohort readiness and the cited-explanation wedge.
2. **Warm intros** to 8–10 academies; book pilot conversations.
3. **Land 1–2 pilot cohorts** on a manual letter of agreement (no payment gateway needed yet) — free or discounted, in exchange for usage and a testimonial.
4. **Instrument and report** — weekly cohort readiness back to the instructor; this report *is* the retention mechanism and the renewal case.
5. **Convert pilots to paid annual** once the entity + ZATCA are live; use the references to open the next tier of schools.

5. What has to be built (and what doesn't yet)

Build now (not gated by the entity):

- The instructor/admin dashboard — `spec-instructor-dashboard.md` (multi-tenant model + rules).
- The school deck and seeded demo cohort.
- A "request seats" enquiry path on `schools.html` (the page already sells this).

- Seat-entitlement data model — `users/{uid}` plan carries a `school` entitlement + cohort id.

Defer to the business track (gated by `phase0.md` P0-3):

- ZATCA VAT registration + Fatoora e-invoicing.
- mada-capable gateway + recurring/bulk billing.

6. Success metric for the quarter

One signed pilot cohort and one reference-able logo beats any amount of consumer polish. That single proof point is the thing a funded competitor cannot quickly replicate — and the thing that turns the channel from open to defended.

7. The risk this closes

Per the teardown, the move to fear most is a competitor **buying the channel** — exclusive ATO prep partnerships locked before we register the entity. Landing pilot cohorts now, even unpaid, is the direct counter: it is far harder to displace an incumbent already running a school's cohort than to sign a school that has no platform yet.